

Yanyi Pu

PhD Researcher in Computer Science | University of Sheffield

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Google Scholar

Research Profile

Natural language processing, language model evaluation and agentic AI, with an interest in legal applications and other high-stakes domains. Research on model reasoning, decision-making and collaboration, and on evaluating capabilities, limitations, reliability and interpretability to support human expertise.

Education

University of Sheffield	Sheffield, UK
PhD in Computer Science	Aug 2025 – Present
University of Cambridge	Cambridge, UK
MPhil in Advanced Computer Science, NLIP Group (Distinction)	Oct 2022 – Jul 2023
University of Sydney	Sydney, Australia
Master of Data Science (Distinction)	Feb 2020 – Aug 2021
University of New South Wales	Sydney, Australia
Bachelor of Commerce (Accounting & Finance), Distinction	Jul 2017 – Feb 2020

Publications & Accepted Papers

- **Yanyi Pu**, Damian A. Gonzalez-Salzberg, Zheng Yuan, & Nikolaos Aletras. (2026). How Much is a Human Right Worth? ECtHR-NPD: A Benchmark for Predicting Non-Pecuniary Damage Awards. *EMNLP 2026, Main Conference*.
- Jiang, X., & **Pu, Y.** (2023). Exploring Time Granularity on Temporal Graphs for Dynamic Link Prediction in Real-world Networks. *Temporal Graph Learning Workshop @ NeurIPS 2023*. (Equal contribution)
- Meidiana, A., Hong, S. H., **Pu, Y.**, Lee, J., Eades, P., & Seo, J. (2022). DSS: Drawing Dynamic Graphs with Spectral Sparsification. *EuroVis 2022*.

Research Experience

University of Sheffield — NLP Group	Sheffield, UK
<i>PhD Researcher</i>	Aug 2025 – Present
• Research on legal NLP, including ECtHR-NPD, a benchmark for predicting non-pecuniary damage awards; related paper accepted to the EMNLP 2026 Main Conference. • Investigating reasoning, decision-making and collaboration in language models and AI agents, with a focus on legal applications and other high-stakes domains. • Developing methods to evaluate and improve model capabilities, reliability and interpretability.	
University of Cambridge — NLIP Group	Cambridge, UK
<i>Research Student</i>	2022 – 2023
• Studied explanation generation and logic-based reasoning in natural language understanding. • Designed prompting and distillation strategies for reasoning-oriented language models; evaluated explanation quality and computational efficiency.	
University of Sydney — Information Visualisation Research Group	Sydney, Australia
<i>Research Assistant</i>	2020 – 2021
• Researched dynamic graph analysis and visualization with faculty and PhD researchers. • Contributed to algorithm design and experimental evaluation for scalable graph visualization.	

Teaching & Service

COM6115 Text Processing, University of Sheffield	Semester 1 (2026-2027)
Academic Tutor & Teaching Assistant, University of Sydney	2020-2021

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, Java, SQL.

Frameworks & Tools: PyTorch, Hugging Face, NetworkX, Neo4j, Git.

Awards & Scholarships

UKRI CDT Scholarship , Speech and Language Technologies and their Applications, University of Sheffield	2023
International Research Scholarship (Full Tuition) , University of Sydney	2021
Dean's List , University of New South Wales	2018–2019